“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 23

The Discourse on Prema as the Prayojana

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I take refuge in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, the supremely generous, who bestowed on all people, down to the lowliest, His own hidden treasure, not given for so long — the nectar of His love and His name.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 “Now hear of the fruit of bhakti: *prema*, the ultimate goal (*prayojana*). By hearing of it one comes to know *bhakti-rasa*.[3]

4 When *rati* for Kṛṣṇa deepens, it is called *prema*; and that prema is the abiding emotion (*sthāyī-bhāva*) of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.[4]

5 “*Bhāva* is in essence a special *śuddha-sattva*, pure spiritual existence; it is like a ray of the sun of prema, and by its tastes (*ruci*) it softens the heart.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.1)[5]

6 These, then, are the two marks of *bhāva*: its essential (*svarūpa*) and its attendant (*taṭastha*) characteristic. Now, Sanātana, hear the marks of prema.

7 “When *bhāva* has completely softened the heart, is marked by an intense feeling that ‘He is mine’ (*mamatva*), and has become dense in its nature, the wise call it prema.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.1)

8 “The exclusive feeling ‘He is mine’ (*ananya-mamatā*) towards Viṣṇu alone, joined with prema — this is what Bhīṣma, Prahlāda, Uddhava and Nārada call *bhakti*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.2)[6]

9 If by some good fortune faith (*śraddhā*) awakens in a jīva, he then seeks the company of sādhus.

10 From the company of sādhus come hearing and chanting (*śravaṇa-kīrtana*), and by *sādhana-bhakti* all *anarthas* are removed.

11 When the *anarthas* have been removed, steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) in bhakti arises. From steadiness, taste (*ruci*) for hearing and the other practices is born.

12 From taste comes deep attachment (*āsakti*) to bhakti, and from attachment the sprout of love for Kṛṣṇa is born in the heart.

13 When that *rati* deepens, it takes the name *prema*. That prema is the ultimate goal (*prayojana*), the abode of all bliss.

14 “First comes faith, then the company of sādhus, and then the practice of worship (*bhajana-kriyā*). From it comes the removal of *anarthas*, then steadiness (*niṣṭhā*), and after that taste (*ruci*).[7]

15 Then come attachment (*āsakti*) and *bhāva*, and then prema arises. This is the order in which prema appears in those who practise *sādhana*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.15–16)

16 (Lord Kapila to His mother Devahūti:) “In the company of the saints there are talks revealing My power, delightful to the heart and to the ear. By relishing them one quickly comes to faith in Me, the path of liberation, and after it to attraction (*rati*) and love (*prema-bhakti*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.25)[8]

17 All the scriptures describe such signs in one in whose heart this sprout of *bhāva* has appeared.

18–19 “Forbearance, never wasting time, detachment, freedom from pride, firm hope (*āśā-bandha*), eager longing (*samutkaṇṭhā*), a constant taste for singing the holy name, attachment to describing His qualities and love for the places where He dwelt — these and other *anubhāvas* are seen in a person in whom the sprout of *bhāva* has arisen.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.25–26)[9]

20 One in whose heart this new sprout of love has appeared is not disturbed by anything worldly.[10]

21 “O brāhmaṇas, and you, goddess Gaṅgā, know me as one who has surrendered, whose heart is fixed on the Lord. Let a magic creature sent by the brāhmaṇa, or Takṣaka himself, bite me as it will — you go on singing the narrations of Viṣṇu.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.19.15)[11]

22 He lets no moment pass in vain, without connection with Kṛṣṇa. Worldly enjoyment, mystic powers and the objects of the senses do not appeal to him.[12]

23 “Constantly praising Him with words, remembering Him with the mind and bowing down to Him with the body, the devotees are still not satisfied. With tears flowing from their eyes, they offer their whole life to Hari alone.” (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 12.38)

24 “Longing for Uttamaśloka, Bharata, while still young, cast off like so much filth his wife and sons, his friends and kingdom — all so dear to his heart and so hard to leave.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.14.43)

25 Though he is the best of all, he considers himself lowly, and he knows for certain that Kṛṣṇa will show him mercy.[13]

26 “This crest jewel of kings, bearing *rati* for Hari, wanders begging alms in the city of his enemies and honours even a dog-eater.” (Padma Purāṇa)[14]

27 “I have no prema, no bhakti of hearing and the rest, no Vaiṣṇava yoga, no knowledge, no pious deeds — alas, not even a good birth. Yet, O Beloved of the gopīs, my hope in You, who grant the lowly more than they deserve, has roots that cannot be cut, and it torments me — alas, alas!” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.35)[15]

28 In *samutkaṇṭhā*, eager longing, craving always prevails; and with a constant taste for singing the holy name, he is always chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

29 “O flute-player, know that Your boyish charm and my restlessness are wonders of the three worlds, known only to You and me. What then shall I do to gaze on Your charming lotus face with my own eyes, when we are alone?” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 32)[16]

30 “O Govinda, today this young girl sings the string of Your names in a sweet voice, while from Her blue-lotus eyes tears fall like drops of honey.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.38)[17]

31 He is always attached to describing Kṛṣṇa’s qualities, and he always lives in the places of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes.

32 “Sweet, sweet is the form of this Lord; sweet, sweet is His face, sweet indeed; and this gentle smile, fragrant with honey — ah, it is sweet, sweet, sweet, sweet!” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 92)[18]

33 “O lotus-eyed Lord, when shall I dance on the bank of the Yamunā, chanting Your names with tears in my eyes?” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.156)

34 I have described these signs of *rati* for Kṛṣṇa. Now, Sanātana, hear the signs of love for Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-prema*).[19]

35 Even the wise cannot understand the words, actions and ways of one in whose heart love for Kṛṣṇa has risen.[20]

36 “The ways of the fortunate soul in whose heart this new prema has blossomed are very hard to understand, even for those who know the scriptures.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.17)

37 “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)[21]

38 As prema gradually increases, it becomes *sneha*, *māna*, *praṇaya*, *rāga*, *anurāga*, *bhāva* and *mahābhāva*.[22]

39 It is like the seed, the sugarcane, its juice, molasses, raw sugar, refined sugar, white sugar, sugar candy, rock candy and pure rock candy.[23]

40 Just as these become purer step by step and their taste increases, so the relish of *rati*, prema and the stages beyond grows ever richer.[24]

41 *Rati* is of five kinds, according to the nature of the devotee: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*.[25]

42 These five *sthāyī-bhāvas* become the five *rasas*, in which the devotee is happy and Kṛṣṇa comes under his control.[26]

43 When prema and the other abiding emotions (*sthāyī-bhāva*) meet with their ingredients (*sāmagrī*), devotion to Kṛṣṇa at last takes the form of rasa.

44 *Vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, sāttvika and *vyabhicārī*: when these four combine with it, the *sthāyī-bhāva* becomes rasa.

45 When yogurt is mixed with sugar, black pepper and camphor, it becomes the drink called *rasālā*, whose taste is like nothing else.

46 *Vibhāva* is of two kinds: the support (*ālambana*) and the stimulus (*uddīpana*). The sound of the flute and the like are *uddīpana*; Kṛṣṇa and His devotees are *ālambana*.[27]

47 The *anubhāvas* are smiling, dancing, singing and other outward signs (*udbhāsvara*). Being stunned (*stambha*) and the rest, the sāttvika states, are counted among the *anubhāvas*.[28]

48 Despondency (*nirveda*), joy (*harṣa*) and the rest are the thirty-three *vyabhicārī-bhāvas*. When all these combine, rasa becomes wonderful.[29]

49 *Rasa* is of five kinds: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*. In *madhura-rasa* the mood of *śṛṅgāra*, the love of the beloveds, predominates.[30]

50 In *śānta-rasa*, *śānti-rati* develops as far as *prema*; *dāsya-rati* gradually increases as far as *rāga*.

51 *Sakhya-rati* and *vātsalya-rati* reach the limit of *anurāga*. In Subala and his companions the glory of prema extends as far as *bhāva*.

52 The *rasas* beginning with *śānta* have two divisions, union (*yoga*) and separation (*viyoga*). In *sakhya* and *vātsalya*, union and separation have many subdivisions.

53 The *bhāvas* called *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha* are found only in *madhura-rasa*: *rūḍha* in the queens, and *adhirūḍha* in the gopīs.[31]

54 *Adhirūḍha-mahābhāva* is of two kinds: in union it is called *mādana*, and in separation *mohana*.

55 In *mādana* there are endless varieties, such as kissing. *Mohana* has two divisions: bewildered agitation (*udghūrṇā*) and wondrous talk (*citra-jalpa*).

56 *Citra-jalpa* has ten parts, named *prajalpa* and so on. The ten verses of the *Bhramara-gītā*, the Song to the Bee, are the evidence of this.[32]

57 Bewildered agitation (*udghūrṇā*) and helpless actions (*vivaśa-ceṣṭā*) are called divine madness (*divyonmāda*). In separation Kṛṣṇa appears before the gopī, and she even takes herself to be Kṛṣṇa.[33]

58 *Śṛṅgāra* is of two kinds, union (*sambhoga*) and separation (*vipralambha*). Union has endless aspects; there is no end to them.[34]

59 Separation (*vipralambha*) is of four kinds: longing before meeting (*pūrva-rāga*), loving pique (*māna*), separation by distance (*pravāsa*)

and the feeling of separation even in the beloved's presence (*prema-vaicittya*).[35]

60 *Pūrva-rāga*, *pravāsa* and *māna* are well known in Rādhikā and the other gopīs; *prema-vaicittya* is seen in the queens, as the Tenth Canto describes.

61 (The queens of Dvārakā:) "O kurarī bird, you lament without sleep and do not even lie down, while at night the Lord sleeps in this world, His awareness hidden. Can it be, O friend, that like us you have had your heart deeply pierced by the generous, playful glance and smile of the lotus-eyed one?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.90.15)[36]

62 Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is the crest-jewel of heroes (*nāyaka*), and Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the crest-jewel of heroines (*nāyikā*).

63 "Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, is the crown jewel of all heroes, for in Him all great qualities shine eternally." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.17)[37]

64 "The goddess (*devī*) Rādhikā is declared to be full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*). She is the supreme deity; all the Lakṣmīs are within Her; She is the whole of splendour (*sarva-kānti*) and the supreme enchantress." (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)[38]

65 Kṛṣṇa's qualities are endless, and sixty-four of them are principal. Hearing of each one of them delights the devotees' ears.

66 "This hero (1) has beautiful limbs, (2) bears all auspicious marks, and is (3) delightful to see, (4) radiant, (5) strong and (6) ever youthful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.23)[39]

67 “He (7) knows many wondrous languages, (8) is truthful in speech and (9) speaks pleasantly; He is (10) eloquent, (11) deeply learned, (12) intelligent and (13) brilliantly quick-witted.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.24)

68 “He is (14) artful, (15) clever, (16) expert, (17) grateful and (18) firm in His vows; (19) He knows what befits place, time and person; (20) He sees through the eye of scripture; He is (21) pure and (22) self-controlled.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.25)

69 “He is (23) steadfast, (24) restrained, (25) forgiving, (26) grave, (27) composed, (28) equal to all, (29) generous, (30) righteous, (31) heroic and (32) compassionate, and (33) He honours those worthy of honour.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.26)

70 “He is (34) courteous, (35) humble and (36) bashful; (37) He protects the surrendered; He is (38) ever happy, (39) the friend of His devotees and (40) subdued by love; and (41) He does good to all.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.27)

71 “He is (42) mighty, (43) famous, (44) loved by the people, (45) the shelter of the saintly, (46) the captivator of women’s hearts, (47) worshipped by all and (48) supremely opulent.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.28)

72 “He is (49) the greatest of all and (50) the Lord. These fifty qualities of Hari have been proclaimed; like oceans, they are unfathomable.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.29)

73 “Although these qualities are at times found in living beings, there they are only tiny drops; in complete fullness they shine only in the Supreme Person (*Puruṣottama*).” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.30)

74 “Now there are five qualities that exist in part in Śiva and others: (51) He is always established in His own nature (*svarūpa*), (52) He knows all,

and (53) He is ever new." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.37)

75 "(54) His limbs are concentrated being, consciousness and bliss — His form is dense consciousness and bliss; and (55) all perfections are under His control and serve Him." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.38)[40]

76 "Now five qualities are described that are present in the Lord of Lakṣmī (Nārāyaṇa) and His other forms: (56) He has great, inconceivable power, and (57) His body holds millions of universes." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.39)[41]

77 "(58) He is the seed of all the avatāras; (59) He grants liberation to the enemies He slays; (60) He attracts even the self-satisfied (*ātmārāma*). In Kṛṣṇa these qualities are truly wondrous." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.40)

78 "(61) He is an ocean whose waves are pastimes more wondrous than all wonders; (62) the circle of His beloved ones is adorned with incomparable, sweet love." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.41)

79 "(63) The sweet call of His flute attracts the minds of the three worlds; (64) the beauty of His form, which none can equal or surpass, astonishes all beings, moving and unmoving." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.42)[42]

80 "His pastimes, the abundance of beloved ones bound to Him by love, and the sweetness of His flute and of His form — these four are declared to be Govinda's unique qualities. Thus sixty-four qualities of four kinds have been described." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.43–44)[43]

81 Śrī Rādhikā's qualities are endless, and twenty-five of them are principal. By these qualities Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, is brought under Her control.

82 “Now the chief qualities of the Queen of Vṛndāvana are glorified. She is (1) sweet and (2) ever youthful; (3) Her sidelong glances are restless, and (4) Her smile is radiant.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 11)

83 “(5) She is rich in beautiful lines of good fortune; (6) Her fragrance maddens Mādhava; (7) She is expert in the wide art of song; (8) Her speech is charming; (9) She is skilled in playful jesting (*narma*).” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 12)

84 “She is (10) modest, (11) full of compassion, (12) artful, (13) skilful, (14) bashful, (15) ever keeping to what is proper, (16) steadfast and (17) grave.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 13)

85 “(18) She is rich in graceful pastimes; (19) She thirsts for the highest excellence of *mahābhāva*; (20) She is the abode of the love of Gokula; (21) Her fame shines throughout all the worlds.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 14)

86 “(22) Her elders bestow great affection on Her; (23) She yields to the loving friendship (*praṇaya*) of Her companions; (24) She is the chief of Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds; (25) Keśava is ever obedient to Her.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 15)

87 The hero and the heroine are the two supports (*ālambana*) of rasa, and the best of these two are Rādhā and the son of the king of Vraja.

88 In the same way, in servitude the servants and in friendship the friends are its supports. Now hear how rasa arises and what its marks are.[44]

89–91 “There are devotees whose faults have been washed away by devotion and whose hearts are clear and bright. They are attached to the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and delight in the company of *rasikas*. The wealth of happiness in devotion to Govinda’s feet has become their very life, and

they perform only those practices that are intimately bound up with prema. In the hearts of such devotees *rati* shines — bliss by its very nature, illumined by two kinds of impressions (*saṁskāra*), past and present — and it attains the state of rasa." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.7–9)

92 "When Kṛṣṇa and the other *vibhāvas*, together with the remaining ingredients of rasa, have entered the path of experience, this *rati* rises to the very summit of mature, wondrous bliss." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.10)[45]

93 Non-devotees cannot taste this rasa; it is Kṛṣṇa's devotees who relish it.[46]

94 "This rasa of the Lord is in every way inaccessible to non-devotees; it is relished only by devotees for whom His lotus feet are everything." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.131)

95 Thus I have briefly described the goal (*prayojana*). This love for Kṛṣṇa is the fifth goal of human life (*pañcama-puruṣārtha*), the greatest wealth.

96 Earlier, at Prayāga, I infused power into your brother Rūpa so that he could expound rasa.[47]

97 You too must spread the scriptures of devotion and recover the lost holy places of Mathurā.

98 Compose a scripture of devotional law (*bhakti-smṛti*) on service to Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana and on the conduct of Vaiṣṇavas, and spread it."[48]

99 Then the Lord taught him fully the way of fitting renunciation (*yukta-vairāgya*) and forbade dry renunciation and dry knowledge altogether.[49]

100–101 “One who bears no hatred towards any being, who is friendly and compassionate, free from the sense of ‘mine’ and from false ego, equal in sorrow and joy, and forbearing; who is ever content, a yogī, self-controlled and firm in resolve, with mind and intelligence fixed on Me — such a devotee of Mine is dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.13–14)[50]

102 “One by whom the world is not disturbed and who is not disturbed by the world, who is free from elation, envy, fear and anxiety — he too is dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.15)

103 “My devotee who expects nothing, who is pure and expert, impartial and free from distress, and who has given up all self-seeking undertakings, is dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.16)[51]

104 “One who neither rejoices nor hates, neither grieves nor desires, who has given up both the auspicious and the inauspicious, and who is full of devotion — he is dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.17)[52]

105–106 “One who is the same to foe and friend, the same in honour and dishonour, in cold and heat, in joy and sorrow; who is free from attachment; to whom blame and praise are alike; who is restrained in speech and content with whatever comes; who has no fixed home, whose mind is steady and who is full of devotion — such a person is dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.18–19)

107 “But those who, full of faith and holding Me as the highest, devotedly follow this nectar of dharma as I have declared it — such devotees are exceedingly dear to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.20)

108 “Are there no rags lying on the road? Do the trees, which sustain others, no longer give alms? Have even the rivers dried up? Are the caves closed? Does the Unconquerable Lord not protect those who take refuge in

Him? Why, then, do the wise serve those who are blinded by the pride of wealth?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.2.5)

109 Then Sanātana asked about all the conclusions (*siddhānta*), and the Lord told him all the hidden conclusions of the *Bhāgavata*.

110 The *Harivaṁśa* tells of His eternal abiding in Goloka, at the time when Indra came and offered prayers to Śrī Kṛṣṇa.[53]

111–112 The pastime of the clubs (*mauṣala-līlā*), Kṛṣṇa's disappearance, the "hair-*avatāra*" (*keśāvatāra*) and other contrary explanations, the abduction of the queens and so on — all these are illusory (*māyā-maya*). The Lord taught how to explain them so that they accord with the right conclusion (*siddhānta*).[54]

113 Then Sanātana clasped the Lord's feet and, holding a bunch of straw between his teeth, made this submission:

114 "I am low-born, a servant of the low, utterly wretched — yet You have taught me truths beyond the reach even of Brahmā.

115 What You have spoken is an ocean of the nectar of conclusions; my mind cannot touch even a single drop of it.

116 If it is Your wish to make a lame man dance, then place Your feet on my head and give me Your blessing.

117 Bless me thus: 'May all that I teach you manifest in you.' This blessing of Yours will be my strength."

118 Then Mahāprabhu placed His hand on Sanātana's head and gave him the blessing: "May all this manifest in you."

119 Thus I have briefly told the account of prema as the goal (*prayojana*). The Lord's grace cannot be told in full.

120 Whoever hears the nectar of the Lord's teachings soon attains the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

121 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[55]

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: He gave it without distinguishing the pious from the sinful or the worthy from the unworthy. The edition's heading: "Obeisance to Gaura, the most magnanimous, who gives the Name and prema never given before". ↩
2. The same verse as Madhya 12.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
3. The Lord's instruction to Sanātana continues from Madhya 22. The edition's heading: "Instructions to Śrī Sanātana — (3) the *prayojana*: the fruit of the *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*, is the *sādhya*, *prema-bhakti*". ↩
4. *Anubhāṣya* (heading): *bhāva*, or *rati*, is the fluid, budding state of prema; in its dense, mature state it is *prema* itself. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: the *śuddha-sattva* here is a function of Kṛṣṇa's own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) called *saṁvit*; the tastes are the desire to attain the Lord, to serve Him favourably and to be intimate with Him. ↩
6. The edition's heading: the definition of prema according to the Pañcarātra — words of the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, quoted in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, 1.4.2. ↩
7. The verse number is not printed in the edition (only "॥"). ↩
8. The same verse as Ādi 1.60 (= Madhya 22.83); translation as there. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: when *rati* has awakened, nine signs are seen in the *sādhaka*; *āśā-bandha* is the firm hope of attaining the Lord, and *samutkaṇṭhā* an intense longing for what one desires. ↩
10. The edition's heading: "Explanation of the verse — (1) *kṣānti*, or imperturbability". ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: hearing of the curse of Śṛṅgī, son of the sage Śamīka, Mahārāja Parīkṣit took the vow of fasting until death on the bank of the Gaṅgā; he

welcomed the curse as a blessing and asked the assembled sages to chant *hari-kathā* without cease. ↩

12. The edition's heading: "(2) never wasting time (*avyartha-kālatva*) and (3) detachment from sense gratification". ↩
13. The edition's heading: "(4) freedom from pride (*māna-śūnyatā*) and (5) firm hope (*āśā-bandha*)". ↩
14. The edition's heading: "an example of humility — words of the *Padma Purāṇa*". The king is not named in the verse. ↩
15. The edition's heading: "words of one full of *āśā-bandha* — words of Śrī Prabhupāda, quoted by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī". *Anubhāṣya*: Vaiṣṇava yoga — yoga full of meditation on Viṣṇu, pure *bhakti-yoga*. ↩
16. The same verse as Madhya 2.61; translation as there, with the speaker's pronouns in lower case: here, by the edition's heading, these are the words of a devotee full of *samutkaṇṭhā* — Bilvamaṅgala. *Anubhāṣya*: *viralam* — "in solitude", or "seldom seen". ↩
17. *Adya* — "today", "now" (so both commentators); *bālā*, the young girl, is Rādhikā. ↩
18. The same verse as Madhya 21.136 (there the lines are printed in pairs); translation as there. The edition's heading: "a description of the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's qualities". ↩
19. The edition's heading: "so far the signs of *bhāva-bhakti* have been described; now the signs of (3) *prema-bhakti*". ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: the words, actions and gestures (*mudrā*) of a devotee in whom prema has awakened cannot be understood even by a discerning paṇḍita. ↩
21. The same verse as Ādi 7.94 (= Madhya 9.262); translation as there. ↩
22. The second line is the same as in Madhya 19.178, and the first has the same sense; the translation follows Madhya 19.178 with "gradually". ↩
23. As Madhya 19.179, except for the last item: there *uttama-michari*, "the finest rock candy", here *śuddha-michari*, "pure rock candy". ↩
24. *Anubhāṣya* (heading): *rati* is the seed, and prema has stages of thickening; as they differ, so does the fullness of the taste of rasa. ↩
25. *Madhura* is the love of the beloveds; in the gopīs it is *parakīyā*, so it is not rendered as "conjugal". ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: the *sthāyī-bhāva* subdues the *bhāvas* both favourable and hostile to it and reigns like a good king; here the *sthāyī-bhāva* is *rati* whose object is Kṛṣṇa. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: *ālambana* — Kṛṣṇa as the object (*viṣaya*) of *rati* and His devotee as its abode (*āśraya*); *uddīpana* — His qualities, deeds, dress,

smile, fragrance, flute, horn, ankle bells, conch, footprints, holy places, tulasī, devotees, the day of Hari and the like. ↩

28. *Anubhāṣya*: the *anubhāvas* reveal the *bhāvas* dwelling in the heart — dancing, rolling on the ground, singing, loud weeping, roaring, heavy breathing and the like. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: the *vyabhicārīs* set the *bhāva* in motion (hence they are also called *sañcārī*); like waves they rise and sink in the nectar ocean of the *sthāyī-bhāva*, swell it and become one with it. ↩
30. *Śṛṅgāra* — the love of the beloveds of Vraja; the verse does not speak here of its superiority over the other *rasas*. ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya* (heading): in Dvārakā, in *svakīyā madhura-rati* full of majesty, there is *rūḍha-mahābhāva*; in Vṛndāvana, in pure *parakīyā madhura-rati* full of sweetness, *adhirūḍha-mahābhāva*. The verse number is not printed in the edition (only "॥"). ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the ten kinds are *prajalpa*, *parijalpa*, *vijalpa*, *ujjalpa*, *sañjalpa*, *avajalpa*, *abhijalpa*, *ājalpa*, *pratijalpa* and *sujalpa*; the *Bhramara-gītā* is Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, chapter 47. ↩
33. The edition's heading: "the last state of *divyonmāda* in separation — the highest of all states, supremely wonderful, wholly made of transcendental service to Kṛṣṇa". ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*): without separation union does not reach its fullness; separation nourishes union. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: *māna* is a *bhāva* of the hero and heroine who love each other which, even when they are together, prevents the embraces and glances they long for; *prema-vaicittya* is the pain that, from the nature of the highest prema, comes even in the beloved's presence, from fear of separation. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: the queens' hearts were absorbed in Kṛṣṇa, and though they were right beside Him, the feeling "We are losing Him!" never left them; as if mad, they spoke thus. The edition's heading: "even near Kṛṣṇa the queens, from *prema-vaicittya*, fear separation from Him". ↩
37. *Anubhāṣya*: in Kṛṣṇa all great qualities shine eternally. ↩
38. The same verse as Ādi 4.83; translation as there. The edition's heading: "eight epithets of Śrī Rādhikā — words of the *Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra*". ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya*: the auspicious marks are the thirty-two marks described in the *sāmudrika-śāstra* and the sixteen lines on the body; His youth is the eternal age of *kaiśora*. ↩

40. *Anubhāṣya*: in one reading the last two quarters, beginning with *sva-vaśa… *, are absent. ↩
41. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: these five are found neither in Śiva and the other gods nor in the jīvas; in Kṛṣṇa they are present in full. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: the three worlds — Goloka, Paravyoma and Devī-dhāma. ↩
43. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the four kinds correspond to four levels — ordinary jīvas, Śiva and the other gods, Nārāyaṇa and the other forms of the Lord, and Govinda Himself. ↩
44. *Anubhāṣya*: the best supports in *dāsya-rasa* are the son of the king of Vraja and Citraka, Raktaka, Patraka and others; in *sakhya-rasa*, Śrīdāmā, Sudāmā, Subala and others; in *vātsalya*, Nanda, Yaśodā and others. ↩
45. Verses 89–92 form a single sentence (the edition's heading: *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, 2.1.7–10). ↩
46. *Anubhāṣya*: non-devotees (*abhakta*) are those who crave enjoyment and liberation and have turned away from Hari. The edition's heading: "only a liberated devotee of Kṛṣṇa can taste this spiritual rasa; for a worldly, crude relisher (*kurasika*) it is impossible". ↩
47. The edition's heading: "earlier, at Prayāga, at the Daśāśvamedha-ghāṭa, Śrī Rūpa was taught *kṛṣṇa-rasa*". ↩
48. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *bhakti-smṛti* scripture is the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*. *Anubhāṣya* (to 97–98): the Lord entrusts Sanātana, a Vaiṣṇava ācārya, with four duties — preaching the scriptures of bhakti, recovering the forgotten holy places, establishing the service of Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana by revealing the Deity, and Vaiṣṇava conduct through a book of Vaiṣṇava *smṛti*. Here the Lord's instruction, begun in verse 3, ends. ↩
49. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to use the world in relation to Kṛṣṇa is *yukta-vairāgya*; to take sannyāsa thinking the world worthless is dry renunciation. ↩
50. The edition's heading: "the Gītā gives the external marks (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*) of a devotee dear to Kṛṣṇa — 12.13–20". ↩
51. The edition reads *yo me bhaktaḥ* (the Gītā usually has *yo mad-bhaktaḥ*); the sense is the same, "who is My devotee"; the text follows the edition. ↩
52. The edition omits *na dveṣṭi* (a misprint; see the head of `ed/fixes/Madhya23.txt`). ↩
53. *Anubhāṣya*: after Kṛṣṇa lifted Govardhana, Indra glorified Him: above Vaikuṇṭha is Goloka, the supreme abode, hard to attain even for those who serve Nārāyaṇa (*Harivaṁśa*, Viṣṇu-parva, 19). ↩
54. *Anubhāṣya*: these accounts are not the eternal transcendental pastimes; they were told to bewilder the *asuras*, hostile to Viṣṇu. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*:

the Lord rejected the explanation that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of a hair and taught the pure one: *ka + īśa = keśa*, Kṛṣṇa, “the Lord of Brahmā”. ↩

55. The same verse as Madhya 7.155 (the colophon refrain); translation as there. ↩